

*Department of Computer Science & Applied Physics
Atlantic Technological University*

*Higher Diploma in Science in Software Development
Higher Diploma in Science in Computing in Data Analytics*

Work Placement / Project Alternative module

Option 3 - Using existing workplace / current working role.

- *Here details are provided as to how a current employment role in a workplace may be used to satisfy the H.Dip. Work Placement / Project Alternative module requirements.*

This alternative is suited to candidates who:

- Are currently employed and are happy in their current working role, and where their current work allows them to achieve the four learning outcomes of the H.Dip Work Placement / Project module as detailed below.
- Are currently employed and are happy in their current working role, but can move to a position / project (perhaps temporarily) with their current employer that allows them to achieve the four learning outcomes of the Placement / Project module.

Description of requirements and steps in process:

Summary of the academic requirements of the H.Dip. Work Placement / Project module:

As mentioned previously, the anticipated learning outcomes of the Work Placement /Project module of the H.Dip. programmes are the following:

- 1. *Work efficiently and effectively on a project as part of a team.***
- 2. *Contribute to the strategy of the team in achieving project goals.***
- 3. *Explain the business strategy or the core business of an employer and how the team's work relates to it.***
- 4. *Work autonomously on specified tasks relating to a project.***

It should be observed that many areas of employment would be of a nature that would meet these learning outcomes. For clarity and as noted earlier, the Work Placement / Project Alternative module is an ***experiential*** module, not a *skills acquisition* module. You acquire new skills as you complete the ten formally taught modules on the programme. The Work Placement / Project module then fulfils a different '*experience of work and the workplace or alternatives*' requirement of the programme.

Also as previously noted the Work Placement / Project Alternative module is not “scored” (*i.e.* a % mark is not awarded); it is just graded as either passed or not passed (*i.e.* you have either achieved the module learning outcomes or you have not). Once you have passed all modules, including the Work Placement / Project module, the classification of your final H.Dip award is then calculated from your scores across the ten taught (and examined) modules only.

Overview of employment role specifications to meet module learning outcomes:

In terms of completing a period of work with an employer to fulfill the requirements of the H.Dip. Work Placement / Project module, there are no hard and fast rules per-se. We do however offer the following guidelines to students:

- The typical period of employment undertaken in order to fulfil the requirements of the H.Dip. Work Placement / Project module, would involve at least 160 hours of activity with the company/employer. That might be “full-time” for *e.g.* 4 – 5 weeks or more, or part-time for *e.g.* 16 hours per week for 10 weeks, etc.. In practice there are all sorts of variations on this theme.
- There is no maximum period of employment that has to be undertaken to fulfill the module requirements. *i.e.* you don’t have to stop after ~160 hours if you don’t want to, and if your company/employer wants to keep you on in that particular role.
- There is no minimum or maximum salary. ATU does not need to know the financial (if any) and contractual arrangements you have agreed on with respect to your employment situation. For the purpose of the Work Placement / Project Alternative module we are just interested in the achievement of the four learning outcomes; *i.e.* our interest is academic only.
- ATU does not need to oversee/approve the position (and tasks) you are undertaking to fulfil the Placement / Project module learning outcomes. You and your employer should consider in advance the achievement of the four learning outcomes for the ATU module and just satisfy yourselves that these can be achieved through the employment role on offer. That said, if you have any queries you can email the team looking after the Work Placement / Project Alternative module at hdip-placement-computerscience.galwaymayo@atu.ie

Steps:

1. Email hdip-placement-computerscience.galwaymayo@atu.ie to let the team looking after the H.Dip Work Placement / Project Alternative module when you are starting your employment role to fulfil the module requirements. If you wish you can provide a brief description of the role involved (company name, section, position title), but this is not essential.

2. After a sufficient period of placement has elapsed (*e.g.* ~160 hours, or perhaps longer), and the learning outcomes have been deemed to be achieved, your supervisor/employer should email the Placement/Project team at (hdip-placement-computerscience.galwaymayo@atu.ie) expressing their professional opinion that this is the case. We don't require a detailed report or appraisal of the performance; a simple statement or set of statements that the threshold has been achieved by you, in the professional opinion of the author, is sufficient.

In addition to this, you should send an email to the same address containing a one page synopsis of the employment role you undertook to meet the module learning outcomes. This synopsis should also detail the company/employer name, your section and title.

3. Having received the above two communications in respect of Step 2 and deemed them to be satisfactory, we will then be in a position to award a pass in the Work Placement / Project Alternative module and the associated credits (15 ECTS) to you.

Please note the following in terms of timelines:

A student's results for their programme of study, are considered and then approved at an Exam Board when all the programme modules have been completed. The Exam Board also determines from the results the overall award grade and classification achieved.

If a student's overall programme results are to be considered at the **Winter Exam Board**, all modules must be completed on or before the 31st of December.

If a student's overall programme results are to be considered at the **Summer Exam Board**, all modules must be completed on or before the 31st of May.

If a student's overall programme results are to be considered at the **Autumn Exam Board**, all modules must be completed on or before the 31st of August.

Gareth Roe

Head of Dept. of Computer Science and Applied Physics

ATU Galway City, Dublin Road, Galway

t: +353 (0) 91 742389

e: gareth.roe@atu.ie

e: hdip-placement-computerscience.galwaymayo@atu.ie

e: hdip-computerscience.galwaymayo@atu.ie